STEADFAST MEN

Lesson 18 · If There Is No Wife Yet

Week 18. If there is no wife yet + Know her

Participant worksheet

Steadfast Men
The way of Godly Men
Wes Hart

Read this week: Chapter 21, If there is no wife yet, and Chapter 22, Know her.

One job: Name which of the three men you are, and whether you have been living as though life has not started. And the one area you know least about your wife, or if single, what a sister practice would expose.

The line

A steadfast man stops waiting, picks up the weight, goes first, and works for God's pay, not the room's.

Write it once.

_____

_____

> **1 Corinthians 7:17 NIV**
> Nevertheless, each person should live as a believer in whatever situation the Lord has assigned to them, just as God has called them. This is the rule I lay down in all the churches.

> **Proverbs 20:5 NIV**
> The purposes of a person's heart are deep waters, but one who has insight draws them out.

Name it

Which of the three men you are, and whether you have been living as though life has not started. And the one area you know least about your wife, or if single, what a sister practice would expose.

_____
_____
_____

Do this week

Never married: pick one thing from what a single man builds and do it before the week is out.

Single again: pick one from the same list; one honest sentence to God about your grief and one about your part.

Married: ask her one question from the thin area; listen without fixing; write it down; start the page.

Single practice: ask your mother or sister one real question; same listening.

The thing / question / what I heard:

_____
_____

Tell a brother

Tell him which man you are and which thing you picked. If divorced and thinking about dating, tell him that and ask whether you are ready. If married, tell him what you found out that you did not know. Do not let either of you say I know her pretty well.

I told (name): _____ on (day): _____

He will ask: _____

Alone: still tell one man. Same week.

Carry this

If there is no wife yet, you are not waiting to start. You are a man with a garden, and it needs working today. Proximity is not knowledge. Study her. Write it down.

Write it once.

_____

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Leader guide

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Before the room

Read this week: Chapter 21, If there is no wife yet, and Chapter 22, Know her.

Aim: If there is no wife yet, you are not waiting to start. Proximity is not knowledge. One hit on the double.

One job: Name which of the three men you are, and whether you have been living as though life has not started. And the one area you know least about your wife, or if single, what a sister practice would expose.

Pitfall: Two chapters, one hour, one hit. Do not turn it into a couples class. Singles are in the rule, not a cameo. Do not reprint last week's destiny card as the whole hour. Kind: yet is not a taunt. A girlfriend is not the stamp.

Time: about an hour. Church, small group, or a man alone.

A steadfast man stops waiting, picks up the weight, goes first, and works for God's pay, not the room's.

Say it. Do not unpack it. Tonight is the house he already has, then the woman he has been guessing at.

> **1 Corinthians 7:17 NIV**
> Nevertheless, each person should live as a believer in whatever situation the Lord has assigned to them, just as God has called them. This is the rule I lay down in all the churches.

> **Proverbs 20:5 NIV**
> The purposes of a person's heart are deep waters, but one who has insight draws them out.

Open (2-3 min)

A garment bag still on the hook after a good wedding. He lives like the real life is the one with a first dance. Then a photo on the fridge. He thinks the still is current.

Say the four. Sit down.

Hit

One hit. Garden now, then study her.

Assigned. Called. Live as a believer in it. If there is no wife yet, you are not waiting to start. You are a man with a garden, and it needs working today. A ring is a gift. It is not a promotion into manhood.

Then deep waters. Proximity is not knowledge. Insight draws them out. Present tense. Study her. Write it down. If single, practice the same listening on your mother or sister.

Point at both chapters. Then shut up.

Table

Three. Wait.

1. Which of the three men are you, and have you been living as though life has not started?
2. What area do you know least about your wife, or if single, what would a sister practice expose?
3. What will you build or ask this week?

Young: a girlfriend is not the stamp. Single: this is your page; unpack; set the table; ask clearly or release honorably. Married: she already knows if you are a student or a visitor. Hurt: yet is not a taunt. Older: never-married is not a mascot; thirty years is not the same as current. The job going well: a beautiful place can still be a hotel.

Run the closer

One seat. One build or question. One page.

Name it. Which of the three men you are, and whether you have been living as though life has not started. And the one area you know least about your wife, or if single, what a sister practice would expose.

Do this week. If you have never married, pick one thing from what a single man builds and do it before the week is out. If you are single again, pick one from the same list and add one honest sentence to God about your grief and one about your part. If you are married, ask her one question from the thin area and listen for the whole answer without fixing, then write it down

and start the page. If single, ask your mother or sister one real question and practice the same listening.

Tell a brother. Tell him which man you are and which thing you picked. If divorced and thinking about dating, tell him that and ask whether you are ready. If married, tell him what you found out that you did not know. Do not let either of you say I know her pretty well.

Carry this. If there is no wife yet, you are not waiting to start. You are a man with a garden, and it needs working today. Proximity is not knowledge. Study her. Write it down.

If he only hears that he wants to get married, or that he wants a better marriage, he nods and goes back to the bag. Get the seat and the ask on the page.

Solo note

Read both chapters. Name the seat. Do the build or the question the same week. Tell one man. You are not waiting to start.

Do not open week 19.